

HARMONIOUS PAINTINGS

Color is one of the most direct ways of expression available to you when you paint. The instant you use colors together, they form an association with one another that helps to

suggest the mood of the painting. Limiting colors to complementary opposites enables you to create simple, vibrant paintings with a range of harmonious tones.

Red and green



The reflective yellow contrasts with the dark purple.

The green body of the T-shirt makes the red arms stand out.

Red is a forceful color and is made more vibrant here by its proximity to green. The boy's pose is relaxed but the liveliness of the red hints at his boisterous nature.

Yellow and purple



Yellow is a reflective color and here it is used in the dancers' skirts to reflect the glare of strong stage lighting. Counterbalancing the yellow with purple highlights the illuminated skirts and helps to ground the dancers' feet.

Blue and orange



Orange and blue have been mixed together to create a range of green neutrals for the trees.

The dominance of blue in this scene suggests cold, still mountain air, in contrast with the orange areas that suggest sunshine and warmth.